the underside of the placket. Hooks and eyes are used mostly in close fitting garments like blouse. They also available in different size, but circular in shape and is made out of metals. Hooks are metals with curved structure at the top with two parallel lines and finished with two circles at the bottom. Button hole stitches are made at the circles placing the hook on the garment to fix the hook onto the garment (Figure 12.29).

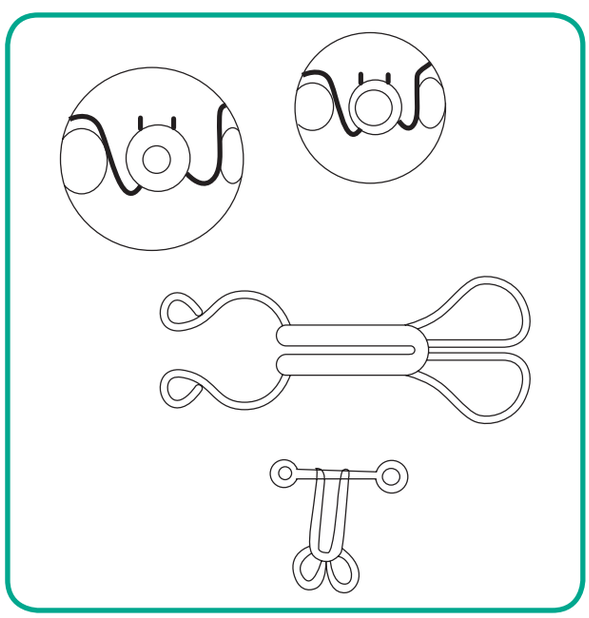


Figure 12.29 Press Button, Hook and Eye

There are two types of eyes, namely metal and thread loops. The metal loops are sub divided as straight and "U" shaped. Both have circles at the end which is used as a mode to sew the eye to the garment with buttonhole stitches.

The loop eyes are also of two types, namely thread loops and fabric loops. Thread loops are made by sewing four to five straight stitches across the under lap to match the hook, using same colour thread as the garment. Buttonhole stitch is made on these strands. Fabric loops are made of strips of fabric matching the garment. These strips are made into tube



Figure 12.30 Hooks

like structure, turned to push the seams inside, to give a neat loop. This strip is cut and placed on the required area and machined.

They form a loop on the placket open to extend outside to hold the button on the opposite side of the garment. The size and width of the placket varies depending upon the garment and size of the button. These loops can be used for decoration also (Figure 12.30).



When was button first made?

Earliest buttons were used by the people of the Indus Valley. These were mostly made out of stones, shell or metals like copper or iron. Buttons were used like brooches or pins, to fasten loose and flowing clothes like a toga, by the Romans. Functional buttons with buttonholes for fastening or closing clothes appeared first in Germany in the 13th century.



Buttons

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